Careers at UA

Entomology Collections Manager

APPLY NOW

JOB NUMBER:
524375

CLASSIFICATION:
Library Professional 3

GRADE:
Grade 81

WORK TYPE:
On Campus, Staff Full-time

ADMINISTRATIVE UNIT:
University of Alaska Fairbanks

SCHOOL/BUSINESS UNIT:
UA Museum of the North

LOCATION:
Fairbanks

CATEGORIES:
Arts/Museum, Research/Science/Grants

Position Summary:

The University of Alaska Museum of the North (UAMN) Insect Collection is seeking a full-time, term-funded Collection Manager (expertise in Diptera, or Hymenoptera preferred) to help manage and improve our rapidly growing insect collection: https://www.uaf.edu/museum/collections/ento/

Duties:

Contributes to publishing and dissemination of information about Alaska non-marine arthropods through authorship of publications, through reviewing papers for journal

editors, and through reviewing papers for authors before they submit manuscripts to journals. Requires expert knowledge in the field of study. Includes presentations at meetings when appropriate.

Grant and contract solicitation and administration. This requires the ability to work with the curator to help find grant opportunities, write persuasively and collaboratively, knowledge of funding agencies and requirements, creative thinking, and budget preparation and administration. This also involves keeping stock of and purchasing supplies when needed. Requires preparation of reports for granting agencies.

Loan Administration. Specimens are regularly loaned to other institutions worldwide. The process must be completely accountable, legally and institutionally. Requires ability to manage database files, prepare specimens for mailing, knowledge of the collection's loan policies and procedures, as well as federal and international regulations. Requires correspondence with loan recipients to assist and encourage safe return of overdue loans.

Public contact & Exhibit development. The collections manager hosts tours for public schools, tourists, university classes and individuals. Requires knowledge of the educational components of the collection and how they relate to school curricula or tour group knowledge base. Skills needed include public speaking, supervision, and the ability to inspire and educate the public. Collections work closely with the exhibits coordinator and preparator to develop and execute new exhibits as well as refreshing existing permanent exhibits. Requires intimate knowledge of the collection, ability to interpret complex intellectual ideas and convert into educational visual representation.

Specimen acquisition and preparation. The collections manager will prepare specimens to museum standards to reduce the collection's backlog of un-curated material. The collections manager will help collect new specimens during field work that further the mission of the Museum, and prepare them into the collection, (including preparation of DNA-quality samples). Requires physical fitness and field work experience.

Supervision of technicians and volunteers and management of collection usage. Many students who work or volunteer go on to work in the museum profession. The collections manager is expected to provide professional training to these students, preparing them for potential graduate degrees in museum-related fields. This requires knowledge of current professional standards, policies, and procedures. The collections manager will provide oversight of all those working in or with the collection, including visiting researchers.

Cataloging of specimens and management of specimen data. Involves entering data into a database and maintaining the quality of the data as well as the training and supervision of students and lab technicians performing these tasks. Requires knowledge

of entomological relational database management including georeferencing best practices. Obtains, evaluates, and catalogs data on distribution of non-marine arthropods of Alaska from all available sources, such as direct contacts with people statewide by phone and email, unpublished reports, online data sources (eg iNaturalist), and published literature. Requires knowledge of the distribution of Alaskan non-marine arthropods and the networking skills to extract this knowledge from the wider community.

Specimen Identification. Authoritative identification of museum specimens involves taxonomic expertise and the ability to seek external expertise when needed. The Collections Manager will work to reduce the number of unidentified specimens in the collection and keep the database updated with new identifications. This may include preparation of DNA barcodes.

KNOWLEDGE, SKILLS, ABILITIES:	Knowledge of museum protocols, prior experience with similar collections, and advanced training in entomology (MS or PhD preferred). Expert knowledge of at least one large insect order is required with preference given to expertise in Diptera or Hymenoptera. Knowledge of grant writing processes and abilities. Preference will be given to applicants who have 2 or more years experience with Entomology collection specimen databases such as Arctos, Emu, Specify, Symbiota, etc. The successful applicant should be an energetic person who has the ability to work independently or as part of a team and who has excellent organizational skills and a detail-oriented approach to work. The candidate should have knowledge of museum practices and standards for collection care and digitization; excellent oral and written communication skills, and supervisory experience; computer skills; the ability to adapt rapidly to changes in technology; and the ability to interact in a positive and enthusiastic manner with others in the workplace. Experience in authorship of publications and reviewing papers for journal editors. Experience in public outreach & exhibit development.
PREFERRED EXPERIENCE:	1-2 years experience in collections management or equivalent experience.

REQUIRED EDUCATION OR TRAINING:	**A Master's degree in entomology, or equivalent experience, is required.**
SALARY INFORMATION:	This is a full-time, 12-month, term, exempt staff position complete with both a competitive salary and full employee benefits package. New hires will be placed on the UA staff salary schedule, Grade 81, based on education and experience.
SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS TO APPLICANTS:	**Please attach a resume, cover letter, and contact information for three professional references with your application.** **This recruitment is open until filled. A first review will begin on May 22, 2023. To ensure consideration, please apply no later than 11:59 PM on May 21.**

At this time, all university employees are strongly encouraged to vaccinate themselves against the COVID-19 virus. While the federal government is not actively enforcing its COVID-19 vaccine mandates, including its mandate requiring vaccination of federal contractor employees, UAF remains contractually obligated as a federal contractor to comply with those requirements should federal enforcement efforts recommence. As a result, UAF may adjust its vaccination requirements for covered UAF employees (currently Troth Yeddha' campus, and employees working in connection with certain federal contracts) at any time in the future, as needed, in order to comply with its contractual obligations.

The University of Alaska (UA) is responsible for providing reasonable accommodations to individuals with disabilities throughout the applicant screening process. If you need assistance in completing this application or during any phase of the interview process, please contact UA Human Resources by phone at 907-450-8200.

UA is an AA/EO employer and educational institution and prohibits illegal discrimination against any individual: www.alaska.edu/nondiscrimination

The successful applicant is required to complete a background check. Any offer of

employment is contingent on the background check.

Your application for employment with the University of Alaska is subject to public disclosure under the Alaska Public Records Act.

If you have any questions regarding this position, please contact Emilie Nelson at emilie.nelson@alaska.edu or (907) 474 6443.

ADVERTISED:
17 Apr 2023 → Alaskan Daylight Time

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All candidates for employment are subject to a pre-employment screening which includes a review of criminal records, reference checks, and verification of education.

Contact UA Human Resources

Phone: 907-450-8200
Fax: 907-450-8201

Email: ua-hr@alaska.edu
Website: Talent acquisition

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